

PROCEDURAL WRITING

Structure and Organisation

Procedural texts give clear instructions on how to do something. A well-structured procedure is easy to follow and helps the reader achieve a successful result.

THE STRUCTURE OF A PROCEDURE

A good procedure is organised in a logical order so that each step builds on the last.

1 GOAL (OR AIM)

States what the procedure will achieve. It gives the reader a clear idea of the end result.

TIP: Make it specific and engaging.

Goal:
To make
fluffy pancakes
from scratch. ★

2 MATERIALS / EQUIPMENT

Lists everything needed before starting. This helps the reader prepare and makes the process smoother.

TIP: List in bullet points.

You will need:

- 2 cups flour
- 1 cup milk
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp baking powder
- Mixing bowl
- Frying pan

3 METHOD / STEPS

The heart of the procedure! It gives clear, step-by-step instructions in the correct order.

TIP: Use chronological or numbered steps.

4 TIPS / NOTES (OPTIONAL)

Extra advice, warnings or helpful hints to improve the outcome or avoid common problems.

TIP: Use words like **tip**, **note**, or **remember**.

Tip:
Don't overmix
the batter – it
can make the
pancakes tough! ♥

5 CONCLUSION / END RESULT

Reminds the reader of the result or finishes with a final statement.

TIP: End with **success!**

ORGANISATION TIPS

- ✓ Plan before you write.
- ✓ Put steps in a logical order.
- ✓ Use headings and subheadings.
- ✓ Number your steps clearly.
- ✓ Use time words and sequencing words to guide the reader.
- ✓ Check that each step is clear and complete.

USE SEQUENCING WORDS

TO START

→ firstly, to begin with, start by, initially

TO CONTINUE

→ next, then, after that, following, subsequently

TO ADD INFORMATION

→ also, additionally, besides, in addition to

TO SHOW TIME OR ORDER

→ meanwhile, at the same time, finally, eventually

TO END

→ finally, in conclusion, to finish, at last

REMEMBER

A well-structured procedure is like a recipe for success. The clearer and more organised your writing, the easier it is for your reader to follow and achieve the goal! ★

EXAMPLE: SIMPLE PANCAKES

GOAL

To make light and fluffy pancakes.



MATERIALS

- 2 cups plain flour
- 1 cup milk
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp baking powder
- Pinch of salt
- Butter or oil

METHOD (STEPS)

1. In a large bowl, sift the flour, baking powder and salt.
2. In another bowl, whisk the eggs and milk together.
3. Pour the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients and stir until just combined.
4. Heat a little butter or oil in a frying pan over medium heat.
5. Pour ¼ cup of batter into the pan for each pancake.
6. Cook for 2–3 minutes, until bubbles form on the surface. Flip and cook for another 1–2 minutes.
7. Repeat with the remaining batter.

TIPS / NOTES

- Don't overmix the batter.
- Keep pancakes warm in a low oven while cooking the rest.
- Add blueberries or chocolate chips for extra flavour!

END RESULT

Stack them high, add your favourite toppings and enjoy! ♥



WHY STRUCTURE MATTERS



Helps your reader follow easily.



Makes your instructions clear and reliable.



Leads to a successful result.



Shows you are an organised writer.

WRITER'S CHECKLIST

- ☐ Have I stated my goal clearly?
- ☐ Have I listed all materials needed?
- ☐ Are my steps in the correct order?
- ☐ Have I used sequencing words?
- ☐ Is everything clear and easy to follow?



PROCEDURAL WRITING

Language Features

Procedural writers use specific language features to give clear, accurate instructions so the reader can follow the steps easily and safely.

1 IMPERATIVE (BOSSY) VERBS

Gives clear commands or instructions.

EXAMPLE:

Mix the ingredients together in a large bowl.



2 SEQUENCING WORDS AND PHRASES

Shows the order of the steps.

EXAMPLE:

First, peel the banana.
Next, slice it into pieces.
Then, add it to the blender.
Finally, blend until smooth.



3 TIME CONNECTIVES

Helps the reader know when things happen.

EXAMPLE:

Allow the cake to bake for 30 minutes, then let it cool completely.



4 SPECIFIC AND PRECISE VOCABULARY

Uses exact words and technical terms.

EXAMPLE:

Use 250 ml of water, 2 teaspoons of yeast and 500 g of plain flour.



5 MATERIALS AND EQUIPMENT LISTS

Lists what is needed using nouns.

EXAMPLE:

- 2 cups of rice
- 4 cups of water
- 1 saucepan with a lid
- Measuring cup



6 MODAL VERBS AND ADVICE

Shows necessity, possibility or suggestion.

EXAMPLE:

You **should** stir constantly to prevent the mixture from burning.
You **may** add a little more milk if the batter is too thick.



7 CONDITIONAL LANGUAGE

Explains what to do in different situations.

EXAMPLE:

If the mixture is too runny, add more flour, one tablespoon at a time.



8 CONNECTIVES

Links ideas and steps together for a smooth flow.

EXAMPLE:

In addition, sieve the flour to remove any lumps.
Also, greasing the pan will stop the cake from sticking.



9 ADVERBS AND ADJECTIVES

Adds detail about how or what.

EXAMPLE:

Stir **gently** and **continuously** until the mixture is smooth and creamy.



10 PRESENT TENSE

Gives the instructions in the present tense so they are clear and immediate.

EXAMPLE:

Heat the oil in a frying pan.
Add the onions and cook until golden.



WHY THESE FEATURES MATTER



They make instructions clear and easy to follow.



They help the reader complete the task successfully.



They reduce confusion and mistakes.



They show your writing is well organised and effective.

WRITER'S TIP



Use these language features together to make your procedure clear, logical and easy for anyone to follow – even if they have never done it before!



Think like a teacher giving a clear set of instructions to a friend!

PROCEDURAL WRITING

Annotated Exemplar

See how this procedure is structured and how language features are used to give clear, accurate instructions.

1 EYE-CATCHING TITLE

Tells the reader exactly what the procedure is about.

2 GOAL / AIM

States the purpose clearly so the reader knows the end result.

3 MATERIALS / EQUIPMENT LIST

Lists everything needed before the steps begin.

Bullet points make it easy to read.

4 STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

Steps are in a logical order and numbered clearly.

Each step is written in the imperative (bossy) verb form.

5 TIME CONNECTIVES AND SEQUENCING

Words like *first*, *next*, *then*, *after that* and *finally* show the order of steps.

How to Make the Perfect Smoothie

★ **Goal:** To make a healthy, delicious smoothie in just a few minutes.

YOU WILL NEED:

- 1 ripe banana
- 1 cup (150 g) frozen berries
- 1 cup (250 ml) milk (or any milk of choice)
- ½ cup (125 g) Greek yoghurt
- 1 tablespoon honey (optional)
- 1 cup (100 g) ice cubes
- Blender
- Measuring cup and spoons
- Tall glass



6 CLEAR AND PRECISE LANGUAGE

Uses specific words and measurements so the reader can follow accurately.

STEPS:

1. **First**, peel the banana and break it into chunks.
2. **Next**, add the banana, frozen berries, milk and Greek yoghurt to the blender.
3. **Then**, add the honey if you want a little extra sweetness.
4. **After that**, add the ice cubes.
5. Put the lid on the blender and secure it tightly.
6. Blend on high speed for 30–45 seconds, or until the mixture is smooth and creamy.
7. **Stop** the blender and check the texture. If it is too thick, add a little more milk and blend again for 10 seconds.
8. **Pour** the smoothie into a tall glass.
9. **Finally**, enjoy your healthy, homemade smoothie!



7 ADDITIONAL DETAILS / TIPS

Extra information helps the reader be more successful.

8 PRESENT TENSE

The entire procedure is written in the present tense for clarity and immediacy.

9 CONCLUSION / END OF PROCEDURE

Signals that the procedure is complete.

TIPS:

- ★ Use frozen fruit for a thicker, colder smoothie.
- ★ Add a handful of spinach for extra nutrients—you won't even taste it!
- ★ Too thick? Add more milk. Too thin? Add more frozen fruit or ice.
- ★ Clean your blender straight away for easy cleaning.

✓ **You're all done!** You now have a perfect smoothie to enjoy.

WHY THIS PROCEDURE WORKS



Clear goal tells the reader what to achieve.



Organised steps are easy to follow in order.



Precise language helps avoid mistakes.



Sequencing words keep the process smooth and logical.



Tips and details support success and confidence.

WRITER'S NOTE

Good procedural writing is like following a recipe—everything is in the right order, with clear instructions and all the details you need for success!